

THISAL ARIYARATNE

Cyber Security Graduand | Penetration Testing · VAPT · Web, Mobile & API Security

Malabe, Colombo, Sri Lanka • +94 76 467 2025 • thisal687@gmail.com

[LinkedIn](#) • [GitHub](#) • [Portfolio](#)

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Cyber Security graduand (B.Sc. Hons, results pending) and CEH candidate with hands-on experience in vulnerability assessment, penetration testing, and web, mobile, and API security using Burp Suite, Metasploit, and Nmap. Top-three finisher across 8+ national and inter-university CTF competitions and author of 20+ national-level challenges, now building ML-based Android malware detection and Rust security tooling, and seeking a cyber security internship to apply practical offensive and defensive skills.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Security Testing: Vulnerability assessment, penetration testing, web application security, mobile (Android/APK) security, API security, static analysis, OWASP Top 10, digital forensics

Tools: Burp Suite, Metasploit, Nmap, RustScan, Gobuster, Hashcat, Hydra, Wireshark / Tshark, Wazuh, Androguard

Protocols & Auth: TCP/IP, DNS, HTTP/HTTPS, OAuth 2.0, SAML 2.0, JWT, VPN

Programming & Scripting: Python, Bash, Rust, C, C++, C#

Platforms & OS: Kali, Arch, Ubuntu, Windows; Hack The Box, TryHackMe, PicoCTF, CTFtime

PROJECTS

BankShield-LK — ML-Based Android Malware Detection (Mobile & API Security)

[Author](#) | [Academic Research Project](#)

- Built a static-analysis system that flags malicious Android banking APKs at **97.9% accuracy (0.996 ROC-AUC)** by training and tuning XGBoost and Random Forest models on 7,258 de-duplicated Drebin-215 feature vectors with verified zero cross-split leakage.
- Engineered an **Androguard static APK feature extractor** mapping 215 indicators (permissions, API calls, intents) across 8 naming schemas and scoring unseen APKs without executing them, exposed through an async FastAPI service validated by 33 automated tests.
- Hardened an **LLM explanation layer against prompt injection** so the backend authoritatively owns every verdict, shipped end-to-end with a React/TypeScript UI and 222 total automated tests.

Fortress — Cloud IAM / Authentication Security Assessment (Web & API)

[Author](#) | [Academic Report](#)

- Assessed an authentication service across **OAuth 2.0, SAML 2.0, and JWT flows**, identifying critical protocol weaknesses and mapping realistic exploit chains.
- Documented findings, business impact, and prioritized remediation in a structured report mirroring professional VAPT reporting discipline.

AP3X — Rust AI Security Assistant & AI-Assisted SOC Workflow

[Author](#) | [In Development](#)

- Built a Rust terminal AI agent with interactive TUI, multi-model LLM integration (OpenAI, Claude), and secure API-key handling to accelerate Linux security operations and research.
- Extending into an AI-assisted SOC workflow integrating **Wazuh SIEM** with automated alert triage and MITRE ATT&CK mapping across a simulated attack environment.

EXPERIENCE & LEADERSHIP

Challenge Builder & Member — HackKAP, Sri Lanka

2026 - Present

- Designed **20+ CTF challenges** spanning Web Exploitation, Cryptography, Binary Exploitation, Reverse Engineering, Forensics, OSINT, and Steganography for national-level competitions.
- Ran two inter-university CTF events end to end, from challenge QA to live infrastructure.

Team Leader — Cronoz & Flag Hunters CTF Teams

2024 - Present

- Led solve strategy, task allocation, and live coordination, driving **8+ top-four national and inter-university finishes**.

Secretary — Ph4ntom Cyber Security Club, CICRA Campus

Aug 2024 - Present

- Organized in-house CTF competitions and delivered Linux command-line and security-tooling workshops.

CTF ACHIEVEMENTS

- **1st Place** — HackKAP CTF 2024, CICRA Campus CTF 2025, and MEDUSA CTF 2025.
- **Runner-up** — ZeroXArena 2026, SLIIT CS2, LNBTI Battle of the Multiverse 2026, and CryptX 2.0 (UOJ).
- **8+ top-four finishes** across national and inter-university CTF competitions.

EDUCATION

B.Sc. (Hons) Cyber Security (Top-Up) — Wrexham University, UK

Completed - Results Pending (Nov 2026)

Pathway with CICRA Campus, Sri Lanka

Higher National Diploma in Cyber Security — CICRA Campus (affil. Deakin University)

2024 - 2026

Foundation in Cyber Security — CICRA Campus

2024

CERTIFICATIONS

- **Active Directory Red Team Specialist (AD-RTS)** — Credential ID: 6a6761378aed14e94c9074d8 | 2026.
- **Certified Ethical Hacker (CEH), EC-Council** — In Progress.

LANGUAGES

Sinhala (Native) • English

REFERENCES

Mr. Hasitha Gunasekara — Senior Windows Engineer, LSEG; Lecturer, CICRA Campus

Email: hasitha@cicra.edu.lk • Phone: +94 777 444 773